

SECTION DESIGN BLUEPRINT

From emotional intention to note choice — all three systems in one planning step

Use this sheet to design any song section from top down. Each column represents one system's contribution to the same decision — the emotional goal (what you feel), the harmonic scaffold (Harmony OS), the texture and tension density (Voicings OS), and what to protect against.

SECTION BLUEPRINT — ALL FIVE SONG SECTIONS

SECTION	EMOTIONAL GOAL AMF	AMF ZONE DISTRIBUTION AMF	HARMONY OS CHORD POOL HARMONY	VOICINGS OS TEXTURE + TENSION VOICINGS	KEY CONSTRAINT WHAT TO PROTECT
VERSE bars 1–8	Grounded storytelling, low stakes. Let the lyric carry the weight.	Z1 50% Z2 30% Z3 15% Z4 5%	Tonic + Subdominant One secondary dominant (e.g. V/ii) for forward motion. Avoid heavy modal interchange.	Guide tones or thin 3-note voicings. Low tension density — 9th as maximum extension.	Avoid Zone 4 entirely. Don't preview chorus-level sweetness here — save it.
PRE-CHORUS bars 9–12	Building urgency. Rising stakes. The listener should lean forward.	Z1 35% Z2 35% Z3 20% Z4 10%	Subdominant → Dominant Secondary dominants encouraged. Increase harmonic rhythm slightly. End on an open V or V/vi.	Medium texture. Begin adding 9th and 11th tensions. Slightly fuller left hand voicing.	Don't resolve to I — maintain forward momentum. Any resolution here kills the chorus impact.
CHORUS Hook · bars 13–20	Maximum emotional payoff. Memorability above all. The sweetest, most grounded moment in the song.	Z1 60% Z2 25% Z3 10% Z4 5%	Tonic-forward progressions I–IV–V, I–V–vi–IV, or simpler. Avoid complexity — the melody is the star. No modal interchange here.	Fuller voicings. Moderate tensions (9, 13). Thicker left hand. Register should sit above verse range.	Highest melody note must be a chord tone. No Zone 4 at all. Don't let the harmony outshine the hook.
BRIDGE bars 29–36	Contrast, darkness, emotional peak before final release. The listener should feel slightly lost.	Z1 20% Z2 25% Z3 30% Z4 25%	Modal Interchange heavy bVI, iv-, bVII, bIII. Phrygian/Dorian borrowing. Tritone subs OK. Slow harmonic rhythm to let darkness breathe.	Thin guide tones with rhythmic space. High tension density — b9, #11, b13 all available. Let the tension hang.	Avoid strong resolution — keep listener in suspended state. No return to Imaj7 until final chorus arrives.
OUTRO Resolution · final	Completion, peace, earned rest. The emotional debt from the bridge is repaid here.	Z1 70% Z2 20% Z3 10% Z4 0%	Pure diatonic — tonic prolongation I–IV–I or simple tonic drone. Slow harmonic rhythm. No borrowed chords. Let the I chord breathe.	Guide tones only, or single-note melody. No extended tensions. Slow harmonic rhythm. Register often drops below verse.	Zero Zone 4. No borrowed chords. No avoid notes. Any tension here breaks the sense of earned resolution.

WORKED EXAMPLE — BRIDGE IN THE KEY OF C

AMF ZONE TARGET

20% Z1 · 25% Z2 · 30% Z3 · 25% Z4

Melody notes: **FA-TI-RE-MI** over two bars — mostly floating and tense, brief sweet arrival at MI before pulling away again.

HARMONY CHORD POOL

Bar 1: **Fm7** (iv-7 — parallel minor)
Bar 2: **Abmaj7** (bVI — parallel minor)
Bar 3: **Bb7** (bVII — backdoor)
Bar 4: **G7** (V7 — tension peak before chorus return)

VOICINGS TEXTURE

Guide tones only (3rds + 7ths). Add b9 on G7 for maximum tension. **Rhythmic space between chords** — don't fill every beat. Let silence carry weight.

COMBINED RESULT

FA over Fm7 = CT/root (Zone 2, grounded tension)
TI over Abmaj7 = NCT/#11 (Zone 2, pensive)
RE over Bb7 = NCT/3rd (Zone 3, floating)
MI over G7 = NCT/13th (Zone 2, tense-bright)